

Velocity AI

Trade-Specific Discovery Call Playbook

Deep-dive questions tailored to each trade. Use during Phase 2 (Problem Dig) after the universal questions. These surface the pain points that are specific to their trade — the ones that make them think **“this bloke actually gets what I do.”**

***How to use:** After the general operations/quoting/scheduling questions, pick 4–6 from their trade section. Don’t read them like a script — weave them into the conversation naturally. The goal is to get them talking about the stuff that keeps them up at night.*

Companion to: [discovery-call-script.md](#)

Plumbing

Emergency vs Scheduled Work

“What’s your split between emergency callouts and scheduled work? Roughly what percentage?”

“When an emergency comes in at 6pm, what happens to tomorrow’s schedule? How do you shuffle things around?”

“Do you have a dedicated after-hours line, or is it your mobile ringing at 2am?”

Compliance & Paperwork

“How are you handling compliance certificates right now? Are they going straight to the council or are they piling up?”

“Gas compliance — is that something you’re staying on top of easily, or is it one of those things that slips?”

Cash Flow Killers

“How many hot water replacements do you quote per week? What’s your close rate on those?”

“When a drain camera job turns into a bigger relining job, how quickly can you get that revised quote out?”

“Warranty callbacks — are you tracking those properly, or do they just eat into your schedule unplanned?”

Growth Blockers

“If you had a system that answered every call, booked the job, and sent the confirmation — would you be turning work on, or are you already at capacity?”

“Are you losing emergency jobs to competitors because no one picks up the phone fast enough?”

What to listen for:

- Missed after-hours calls → AI voice agent
- Compliance paperwork stacking up → automated certificate generation
- Slow quoting on hot water/relining → quote automation
- No follow-up on quoted jobs → nurture sequences
- Can’t handle more volume → operations overhaul, team scheduling

Electrical

Compliance & Certificates

“How are you managing your electrical safety certificates? Paper forms, an app, or something else?”

“When a certificate needs to go to the QBCC or the council, what's that process look like? Is it smooth or a nightmare?”

“RCD testing for commercial clients — are you doing reminder campaigns for annual testing, or waiting for them to call?”

Solar & Battery

“Are you doing solar installs? What percentage of your work is solar vs general electrical?”

“How do you handle the CEC paperwork and STC claims? Is that streamlined or a pain point?”

“For solar quotes — are you doing site assessments then quoting manually, or do you have a calculator?”

Job Complexity

“Switchboard upgrades — how long between the initial enquiry and actually getting on site? What's slowing it down?”

“When you quote a job and it turns out the wiring needs more work than expected, how do you handle the variation?”

“Do you track which jobs end up being more profitable than others? Like, do you know if commercial or residential makes you more money per hour?”

Team & Apprentices

“How many apprentices have you got? Who manages their training and sign-offs?”

“When you send an apprentice with a licensed sparky, how do you make sure the paperwork reflects who did what?”

What to listen for:

- Certificate management chaos → [automated compliance workflows](#)
- No RCD reminder system → [recurring revenue campaigns](#)
- Manual solar quoting → [quote configurator](#)
- Apprentice management headaches → [job allocation and training tracking](#)
- No visibility on job profitability → [reporting dashboard](#)

Building / Construction

Project Coordination

“How many projects are you running at any one time? And how do you keep track of where each one is at?”

“Subcontractor scheduling — what’s your system for making sure the right trade shows up on the right day?”

“When a subbies doesn’t show or runs late, how does that cascade through your schedule?”

Money & Claims

“Talk me through your progress claim process. How often are you lodging claims, and how long does it take to get paid?”

“Variations — are they getting documented properly on site, or do they turn into arguments at the end of the job?”

“How are you tracking costs against budget during a build? Do you know if you’re on track or only find out at the end?”

Compliance & Council

“Council inspections — how do you manage those bookings and make sure they happen at the right stage?”

“When you get a defect list at handover, how do you track and close out each item?”

Client Communication

“How are you keeping clients updated during the build? Regular updates, or do they just call you constantly?”

“Do you have a system for before-and-after photos and progress documentation?”

What to listen for:

- Subcontractor scheduling chaos → **drag-and-drop scheduling with notifications**
- Slow progress claims → **automated invoicing tied to project milestones**
- Untracked variations → **digital variation orders with sign-off**
- No real-time cost tracking → **project budget dashboard**
- Client communication overload → **automated progress updates**

HVAC / Air Conditioning

Seasonal Demand

“How do you handle the pre-summer rush? Are you turning work away, or are you trying to capture all of it?”

“Do you do any proactive outreach before the season hits — like reaching out to last year’s customers?”

“What happens to your team between seasons? Is there enough maintenance work to keep everyone busy?”

Maintenance Contracts

“Are you doing maintenance contracts? What percentage of your revenue is recurring vs one-off installs?”

“How do you track which units are due for service? Is it a spreadsheet, a system, or just memory?”

“When a warranty is about to expire on a unit, do you reach out to the customer to lock in an extended service plan?”

Technical & Quoting

“For new installs, how are you sizing units? Manual load calcs, or do you have software?”

“Split system vs ducted — do you quote both and let the customer choose, or recommend one? How long does that process take?”

“Parts ordering — when you need a specific part mid-job, how quickly can you source it? Is that ever a bottleneck?”

What to listen for:

- No proactive seasonal outreach → **automated marketing campaigns**
- Maintenance contracts on spreadsheets → **CRM with automated reminders**
- Manual load calculations → **quote configurator**
- Parts sourcing delays → **supplier integration**
- No warranty expiry tracking → **automated upsell campaigns**

Roofing

Storm & Insurance Work

“When a big storm hits, how do you handle the surge? Do you have a system to triage and prioritise?”

“Insurance jobs — what’s your process for dealing with assessors? Is that smooth, or does it slow everything down?”

“After storm season, how many leads do you lose because you couldn’t get back to them fast enough?”

Safety & Compliance

“Height safety compliance — are you managing that in-house? How do you track harness inspections, training expiry?”

“Safe Work Method Statements — are you creating those from scratch each job, or do you have templates?”

Estimation & Materials

“How accurate are your material estimates? How often do you end up short or over-ordering?”

“For re-roofing jobs, are you doing the measurements manually on site or using satellite tools?”

“Colorbond vs tile — do you track which is more profitable for you?”

Documentation

“Before-and-after photos — are you taking those consistently? Where do they live?”

“When a customer calls back 6 months later about a leak, can you quickly pull up what was done?”

What to listen for:

- Storm surge overwhelm → AI call handling + automated triage
- Insurance process friction → document management and assessor communication
- Lost leads during busy periods → automated follow-up
- Safety compliance tracking gaps → digital compliance management
- No job history lookup → CRM with photo documentation

Landscaping

Design to Build

“Do you do the design in-house, or do you bring in a landscape architect? How does that handover work?”

“When a design changes mid-project — and it always does — how do you manage the cost and timeline impact?”

“What’s your quoting process like for a full landscape build? How long from site visit to quote sent?”

Maintenance & Recurring Revenue

“Are you doing ongoing maintenance for past clients? What does that look like?”

“How do you manage maintenance schedules — mowing, hedging, seasonal planting? Is it all in your head?”

“If a maintenance client wants additional work — new garden bed, irrigation fix — how does that get captured?”

Seasonal Planning

“How does your workload shift through the year? What’s your quiet period?”

“Do you do any proactive outreach before spring — like contacting past clients about garden refreshes?”

What to listen for:

- Design change chaos → [digital variation management](#)
- No recurring maintenance system → [CRM with automated scheduling](#)
- Seasonal quiet periods → [marketing automation to fill gaps](#)
- Manual quoting → [landscape quote builder with material calculator](#)
- Supplier coordination issues → [order management system](#)

Painting

Estimation & Quoting

“How do you estimate a job? Are you measuring up manually or using any tools?”

“What’s your accuracy like? How often does a job end up taking longer than you quoted?”

“Do you break down your quotes by room or give a lump sum? What works better for conversions?”

Scheduling & Weather

“Exterior work — how do you manage weather disruptions? What does that do to your schedule?”

“When rain pushes a job back, how do you communicate that to the customer and reorganise?”

Colour & Client Management

“Colour consultations — do you offer that, or do clients come to you knowing what they want?”

“How often do clients change their mind on colour mid-job? How do you handle that?”

Commercial & Strata

“Do you do body corporate or strata work? How does that pipeline work — is it tender-based?”

“Multi-stage jobs — primer, undercoat, topcoat across multiple areas — how do you track what's done?”

What to listen for:

- Inaccurate estimates eating margin → measurement and estimation tools
- Weather schedule chaos → smart scheduling with weather integration
- No waitlist management → automated booking and pipeline management
- Colour change friction → digital colour selection workflow
- Multi-stage tracking gaps → job progress tracking per area

Concreting

Quoting & Measurement

"How are you measuring up jobs? Tape measure and calculator, or do you have something more?"

"For a standard driveway or slab, how long between enquiry and quote sent?"

"Do you include 3D renders or visual mock-ups in your quotes, or is it just a written description?"

Scheduling & Weather

"Concrete is weather-sensitive — how do you manage pours around rain forecasts?"

"When a pour gets pushed back, how does that ripple through your other bookings?"

Team & Equipment

"How many crews are you running? Who coordinates which crew goes where?"

"Equipment maintenance — concrete pumps, bobcats — how do you track servicing?"

What to listen for:

- Slow quoting → automated measurement and quote generation
- Weather coordination chaos → smart scheduling with weather alerts
- No progress documentation → automated photo and update system
- Equipment tracking gaps → asset management system
- Labour coordination issues → crew scheduling platform

Universal Pain Point → Solution Map

Use this to connect what you hear to what you sell, regardless of trade:

Pain Point Signal	What They Say	What You Sell
Missed calls	“Can’t answer when I’m on the tools”	AI voice agent — 24/7 call answering
Slow quoting	“Takes me days to get quotes out”	Quote automation / wizard
No follow-up	“I just hope they come back”	Automated email/SMS sequences
Admin overload	“I’m doing invoices at 9pm”	Full operations automation
Lost leads	“Don’t know how many I miss”	CRM + lead pipeline tracking
Team chaos	“They don’t know what’s happening”	Smart scheduling + mobile app
No marketing	“All word of mouth”	Automated campaigns + review requests
No visibility	“Don’t really know my numbers”	Live dashboards + reporting
Compliance gaps	“Certificates pile up”	Digital compliance workflows
No recurring revenue	“Every month starts from zero”	Maintenance contracts + auto reminders

Red Flags (Not a Good Fit)

- Owner-operator with 0 staff doing <\$150K revenue — too small for ROI at \$499/mo
- Already on Tradify/ServiceM8 AND happy with it — they don’t need another system
- “Just looking for a website” — that’s not what we do, refer them
- Resistant to tech entirely — “I’ve done it this way for 30 years” — they won’t adopt
- Cash business avoiding records — compliance risk, walk away

Key Metrics to Extract

Try to get actual numbers during the call. These become your ammunition in the close:

Metric	Why It Matters
Missed calls/week	even 3/week × average job value = massive annual loss
Admin hours/week	usually 10–15 hours × their hourly rate = real cost

Metric	Why It Matters
Quote conversion rate	most tradies don't know this, which proves they need tracking
Time to send quote	if >24 hours, they're losing jobs
Revenue per employee	benchmark against industry average for their trade
Repeat customer %	if <30%, there's a retention problem
Google reviews	if <50, there's a reputation problem